

Internal inquiry of Jan. 6 cases starts

U.S. attorney for D.C. focuses on prosecutors' use of obstruction statute

BY SPENCER S. HSU, KEITH L. ALEXANDER AND TOM JACKMAN

Edward R. Martin Jr., the interim U.S. attorney for D.C., has asked two top prosecutors in his office to undertake an internal review of its handling of Capitol riot prosecutions, focusing on one of the most heavily litigated counts in the sweeping investigation that President Donald Trump has sought to discredit as a “witch hunt” against him.

The move follows Trump's grants of pardons or sentence commutations to all of nearly 1,600 people charged in one of the Justice Department's largest prosecutions, continuing a striking move to change history's understanding of the Jan. 6, 2021, riot.

It comes on the heels of a White House executive order to the Justice Department and intelligence agencies to hunt for political bias in their ranks.

In an email to staff Monday morning, Martin stated that he had appointed Denise Cheung, chief of the Criminal Division, and Jon Hooks, chief of the Fraud, Public Corruption and Civil Rights section, to lead a “special project” investigating the office's charging of more than 250 Capitol riot defendants with obstructing an official proceeding.

SEE MARTIN ON A2

Reversal: Judge will no longer bar Oath Keepers leader from D.C. **B1**

DOJ fires officials tied to probes of Trump

Acting AG says he ‘does not trust’ members of special counsel team

BY PERRY STEIN

The Justice Department fired more than a dozen officials who worked on the special counsel team that investigated Donald Trump in two separate criminal cases, citing a lack of trust in them, a department spokesman said Monday.

Acting attorney general James McHenry informed the officials of their firings, saying that he “does not trust these officials to assist in faithfully implementing the President's agenda.”

The firings were effective immediately and focused on officials who played key roles in prosecuting Trump, the spokesman said.

In a letter sent to the officials, McHenry referred to Trump's claims that previous administrations weaponized law enforcement to hurt political enemies.

“Nowhere was that effort more salient than in the unprecedented prosecutions the Justice Department vigorously pursued against President Trump himself.”

SEE FIRINGS ON A6



MOHAMMED SABER/EPA-EFE/SHUTTERSTOCK

Thousands of displaced Palestinians make their way toward northern Gaza along the coastal al-Rashid road on Monday.

Gazans head back to scenes of destruction

This article is by Gerry Shih, Abbie Cheeseman, Hazem Balousha, Lior Soroka and Shira Rubin

TEL AVIV — It was just after dawn in Gaza on Monday when, for the first time in 15 months, hundreds of thousands of displaced Palestinians streamed into the enclave's north.

They returned under a provision of the ceasefire agreement between Israel and Hamas, in some cases walking for hours to reach the cratered landscape that was once Gaza's busiest urban center. Israeli troops and tanks had melted away, withdrawing to buffer zones on the territory's

Under ceasefire deal, thousands return north after long displacement

edges.

Families trekked for miles along a coastal road, carrying their children or burlap sacks stuffed with belongings they hastily fled with. Others strapped mattresses onto cars or piled folded tents into truck beds and waited at slow-moving, newly established checkpoints, operated by a group of private security contrac-

tors. In one instance, a man rowed north in a canoe with his family along the Mediterranean coast.

All told, 300,000 Palestinians crossed the Netzarim Corridor after it opened after 7 a.m. on Monday, according to the militant group Hamas. The dramatic mass migration was a reversal from the early weeks of the war, when the Israeli military ordered more than 1 million Palestinians to evacuate south of the corridor — which bisects the Gaza Strip — as it turned the dense, urban north into a dedicated war zone against entrenched Hamas fighters.

On Monday, Daa Asaad, 51,

walked for eight hours from Nuseirat to Gaza City on a potholed road with his six children — a distance of about seven miles. He said he encountered almost nothing during the journey back and knew there would be nothing waiting for him at the end.

“There were no cars, no services along the way, not even water,” Asaad said, describing a scene of destruction in northern Gaza as he rested for the night inside an eye hospital in Gaza City.

On Tuesday morning, he said, he planned to find his destroyed home in Jabalya, one of the worst-

SEE GAZA ON A11

Chinese app stokes fears of challenge to U.S. dominance in AI

This article is by Eva Dou, Aaron Gregg, Cat Zakrzewski, Nitasha Tiku and Shannon Najmabadi

The sudden popularity of a Chinese artificial intelligence app called DeepSeek pummeled tech stocks and captivated Silicon Valley on Monday, prompting debate in political and tech industry cir-

cles about how the United States can maintain its lead in AI.

President Donald Trump said late Monday that DeepSeek's release “should be a wake-up call for our industries that we need to be laser focused on competing to win.”

Trump separately said he planned to place new tariffs on

computer chips produced overseas, a policy that could create further challenges for the U.S. tech industry, which depends heavily on chip manufacturing in Asia.

The DeepSeek app rocketed to the top of the downloads chart in the Apple store over the weekend and remained there Monday after

its release last week by a Chinese start-up of the same name founded in 2023. The app offers similar functionality to OpenAI's popular ChatGPT chatbot, answering questions and generating text in response to a user's queries.

Several tech companies that have banked on a surge of AI interest sold off Monday, with U.S.

chipmaker Nvidia down almost 17 percent, losing \$589 billion in market capitalization. The tech-focused Nasdaq composite index finished the day down 3 percent.

DeepSeek's explosive debut also escalated concerns about China's ability to challenge the U.S. lead in advanced artificial

SEE DEEPSEEK ON A14



SEAN GALLUP/GETTY IMAGES

Marking 80 years since Auschwitz's liberation

Holocaust survivors and world leaders gathered at Auschwitz, the Nazi death camp in Oswiecim, Poland, on Monday. As the far right gains power around the world, survivors voiced concerns that safeguards to “never again” repeating the atrocities of the Holocaust are falling. **Story, A12**

Citizenship order would have sweeping effects

Red tape, errors are likely results of requiring an evaluation of every baby's right to be an American

BY SILVIA FOSTER-FRAU, DAVID NAKAMURA AND MOLLY HENNESSY-FISKE

A month and a half before she was due to give birth, Duilanyela started having contractions and was rushed to the hospital, where doctors performed an emergency C-section and hysterectomy.

The undocumented Venezuelan woman had been grieving her son's traumatic entry into the world. But her perspective changed after Donald Trump took office on Monday and issued an executive order to end birthright citizenship.

Her baby boy was originally due Feb. 24. Instead, he arrived on Jan. 8 — well before Trump's executive order would take effect. Now she takes comfort in knowing there are no questions about his right to U.S. citizenship.

“It doesn't matter the pain I went through, or the scars I have,” said Duilanyela, 31, speaking from the neonatal intensive care unit in Texas where her newborn lay sleeping. She spoke with The Washington Post on the condition that her last name not be used, because she fears being targeted for deportation. “I know he will be able to live in peace in this country.”

The directive has sparked fear and uncertainty for tens of thousands of immigrant families and foreign workers, students and tourists — and left hospitals, state and local governments, and even

SEE BIRTHRIGHT ON A7

Brazil balks: Query made to U.S. after deportees allege abuse. **A12**

ICE sweeps: Schools try to soothe families fearful of crackdown. **B1**

IN THE NEWS

Higher prices ahead? Tomatoes, T-shirts, crude oil and cars, among other things, could get more expensive if Trump imposes increased tariffs on U.S. trading partners. **A6**

Utah land battle At stake is control of public terrain in Western states; conservationists fear more efforts to undo protections. **A8**

THE NATION **Rain eased** the fires in Southern California but brought increased risks of mudslides. **A3** **The White House** ordered a pause on grants and loans from the federal government. **A7**

THE WORLD **Rwandan-backed** rebels clashed with Congo's military over control of the city of Goma. **A10** **Sweden detained** a ship after damage was reported to a data cable in the Baltic Sea. **A11**

THE ECONOMY **Energy economists** said they were puzzled by the Trump administration's math as it targets offshore wind and other renewables in favor of fossil fuels. **A13** **The short-staffed** FDIC rescinded more than 200 job offers amid a hiring freeze. **A14**

THE REGION **Commanders fans** bonded in optimism and disappointment on a train to and from the NFC title game loss in Philadelphia. **B1** **A youth** from Northeast Washington was charged with the felony murder of a 14-year-old in Southwest. **B1**

STYLE **After leading** the Kennedy Center through a growth spurt and a global pandemic, Deborah Rutter will soon step down as president. **C1**

HEALTH & SCIENCE **A small spot** on a man's nose led to a battle that tested his physical and mental resilience. **E1**

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